

AYE
FIT HUB

• NUT • DAY 11

Meal Prep Mastery

Cook Once, Eat All Week

Day 11 of 30 | Nutrition

Awet G. Nway

Mechanical Engineer & Fitness Coach

- Why 80% of diets fail without meal prep
- The 5-step batch cooking system (takes 90 min)
- Best proteins, carbs & veg to prep in bulk
- The container method for perfect macros every meal
- Sample 7-day meal plan you can start this Sunday

01 | Why Meal Prep Changes Everything

The biggest reason diets fail is not lack of motivation — it is **lack of preparation**. When 6 pm arrives and you are tired and hungry, willpower disappears. If unhealthy food is the easiest option, you will take it. Meal prep eliminates that moment entirely: the decision is already made, the food is already cooked.

Decision fatigue is real. Every meal you have to decide, shop for, and cook burns mental energy. Research shows that by evening most people have depleted their capacity for disciplined choices. Prepping once a week removes 15–20 daily food decisions and replaces them with a single Sunday session.

The Meal Prep Payoff

People who meal prep consume 35% fewer calories from takeaway food, spend 40% less on food overall, and are 2× more likely to meet their protein targets daily. One 90-minute Sunday session replaces 5 hours of weekday cooking decisions.

02 | The 5-Step Batch Cooking System

Successful meal prep follows a repeatable system. Miss any step and the session becomes stressful. Follow all five and it becomes automatic within 3–4 weeks.



Figure 1 — The 5-Step Meal Prep Cycle

Step	Action	Time	Key Tip
1 — Plan	Decide this week's meals. Write a simple list: 2 proteins, 2 carbs, 3 veg.	10 min	Rotate proteins each week to avoid flavour fatigue
2 — Shop	Buy in bulk. Stick to the list. Focus on whole foods in the outer aisles.	20 min	Frozen veg is as nutritious as fresh and saves waste
3 — Prep	Wash, chop, marinate. Do all cold prep before turning on any heat.	20 min	Use a large cutting board and batch all chopping first
4 — Cook	Use oven, hob, and rice cooker simultaneously. Multi-task heat sources.	40 min	Roast veg (200°C), cook protein (hob), simmer grains (rice cooker)
5 — Store	Portion into containers while hot. Label with day and meal. Refrigerate.	10 min	Glass containers preserve flavour better than plastic

03 | What to Batch: Protein, Carbs & Vegetables

Not everything needs to be prepped every week. Focus on the three macronutrient categories and pick 1–2 options from each. Rotate weekly to keep meals interesting.

Category	Best Options to Batch	Cook Method	Lasts (Fridge)
PROTEIN	Chicken breast, turkey mince, eggs (hard-boiled), salmon fillet, lentils	Bake, poach or pan-sear without sauce — add sauce fresh each day	3–4 days
CARBOHYDRATES	Brown rice, sweet potato, quinoa, oats (overnight), wholegrain pasta	Rice cooker, boil, or roast. Cook plain — season per meal	4–5 days
VEGETABLES	Broccoli, peppers, courgette, spinach, kale, mushrooms, cherry tomatoes	Roast (200°C, 20 min) or steam. Leafy greens stay raw, dressed fresh	3–4 days
SAUCES/DRESSINGS	Tahini-lemon, Greek yoghurt-herb, homemade tomato, pesto (no cheese)	Mix cold, store in a jar, use to flavour daily meals differently	5–7 days

04 | The Container Method — Macros Made Visual

Tracking macros does not require an app if you use the container method. Divide every container the same way: **35% protein, 35% carbohydrate, 30% vegetables**. For most adults aiming for body recomposition, this split consistently delivers 35–45 g protein, 45–55 g carbs, and 10–15 g fat per meal — without counting a single calorie.

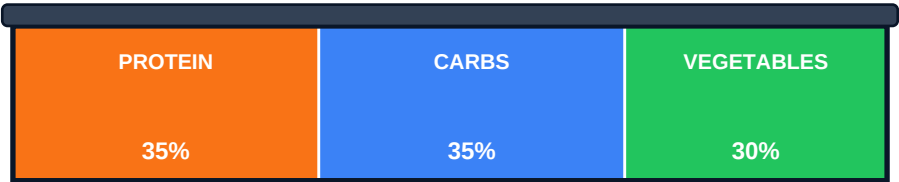


Figure 2 — Macro-Balanced Container Method

Container Size by Goal

Fat loss: 650 ml container (approx. 450–500 kcal per meal). Maintenance: 800 ml (500–600 kcal). Muscle gain: 1 litre (600–750 kcal). Use the same split — just scale the container.

05 | Your Sample 7-Day Meal Prep Plan

The grid below shows a typical Sunday prep covering 5 weekday breakfasts, 5 weekday lunches, and 3 weekday dinners. Tuesday and Wednesday dinners are reheated lunches. Thursday and Friday dinners are freshly cooked (20 min) to break monotony. Saturday and Sunday are flexible — eat out or cook fresh.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
BREAKFAST	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	FRESH	FRESH
LUNCH	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	FRESH	FRESH
DINNER	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	✓ PREPPED	FRESH	FRESH	FRESH	FRESH

Figure 3 — Weekly Meal Prep Coverage (Sunday batch)

Meal Slot	Prepped Option	Protein	Kcal
Breakfast (Mon–Fri)	Overnight oats: oats + Greek yoghurt + banana + chia seeds	22 g	~380
Lunch (Mon–Fri)	Brown rice + baked chicken breast + roasted peppers & broccoli	42 g	~520
Dinner (Mon–Wed)	Leftover lunch container + 1 extra serving of veg	40 g	~490
Dinner (Thu–Fri)	Stir-fried turkey mince + quinoa + fresh spinach (20 min cook)	38 g	~510
Snack (any day)	2 hard-boiled eggs + handful of almonds + apple	16 g	~280

06 | Safe Storage Times

Food	Fridge (≤4°C)	Freezer (≤−18°C)	Do NOT store
Cooked chicken / turkey	3–4 days	2–6 months	With sauce mixed in (freezes poorly)
Cooked fish / seafood	2–3 days	2–3 months	Re-freeze after thawing
Hard-boiled eggs	1 week (unpeeled)	Not recommended	Peeled eggs in water >2 days
Cooked rice / grains	4–5 days	1 month	Leave at room temp >2 hrs
Roasted vegetables	3–4 days	1–3 months	Dress with vinaigrette before storing
Cooked lentils / legumes	4–5 days	2–3 months	—

Day 11 Action — Your First Prep Session

This Sunday: pick 1 protein (chicken breast), 1 carb (brown rice), 2 veg (broccoli + peppers). Cook in 90 minutes. Fill 5 lunch containers using the 35/35/30 split. That is your first meal prep session done. Next lesson — Day 12: Sleep & Recovery — The Overlooked Performance Tool.